TITLE

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1 Introduction

1.1 Collostructional analysis and learner corpora

1.2 Formulaicity in learner language

RQ1. How are type II conditionals dispersed across learner writing tasks present in our analyzed data?

RQ2. Do learners at higher proficiency levels favor different verbs in the protasis of type II conditionals than beginner learners?

RQ3. Does the verbal slot in the protasis of type II conditionals provide evidence for a transition from more formulaic to more productive use of the construction?

2 Methods

2.1 Data: The EFCAMDAT

The EF-Cambridge Open Language Database (EFCAMDAT) Geertzen et al. (2013) is a large-scale learner corpus containing writings from Education First (EF) online English school *Englishtown*. In their courses each level corresponds to eight pedagogical units, after each of which students receive a prompt for a writing task which they must complete in order to advance. The corpus comprises all these writings in their original and corrected forms, along with metainformation about the text and the author (learner ID, country of origin, grade given by a teacher, etc.). An advantage of the EFCAMDAT, beyond being broadly available for researchers at all stages, is the fact that *Englishtown* levels are aligned with the CEFR, making it possible to do a broad range of descriptive analyses of L2 English at globally understood proficency levels.[1]

The version of EFCAMDAT used for this study contained 620.206 learner writings in total. However, it was unlikely for second conditionals to be elicited by most prompts; therefore, after qualitatively inspecting the task prompts, I decided on a subset of 20 tasks whose responses were most likely to contain the construction. The selected units and corresponding writing topics are outlined in Table 1. This subcorpus contains 33.496 student writings and 4.402.652 words

CEFR level	**EF level:Unit**	**Topic ID**	**Words**	**Topic**
A2	6:6	46	290,594	Writing an email of advice
B1	8:3	59	474,441	Making a ‘to do’ list of your dreams
B1	9:3	67	354,123	Making a business proposal
B1	9:4	68	284,752	Signing a waiver to go skydiving
B2	10:1	73	797,218	Helping a friend find a job
B2	10:2	74	492,941	Doing a survey about discrimination
B2	10:3	75	438,282	Requesting a bank loan
B2	10:5	77	313,135	Finding a home for a wealthy client
B2	11:2	82	291,016	Helping a coworker deal with a phobia
B2	11:8	88	24,119	Improving your study skills
C1	13:1	97	244,337	Writing a campaign speech
C1	13:4	100	115,523	Giving advice about budgeting
C1	13:8	104	21,223	Reaching your potential
C1	14:2	106	41,642	Choosing a renewable energy source
C1	14:3	107	61,155	Writing a rejection letter
C1	14:4	108	55,637	Attending a seminar on stress reduction
C1	14:5	109	52,968	Talking a friend out of a risky action
C1	14:6	110	39,465	Applying for sponsorship
C1	15:7	119	5,182	Writing about future lifestyles
C1	15:8	120	4,899	Interpreting a prophecy

Table 1: Topics by Level and CEFR

[1]The availability of large-scale, CEFR-aligned corpora is more limited than one might expect. The most well-known English learner corpus is the Cambridge Learner Corpus (CLC), whose access is highly restricted.

2.2 Extracting conditionals

2.3 Calculating dispersion across tasks

2.4 Distinctive Collexeme Analysis

2.5 Lexical variability

3 Results

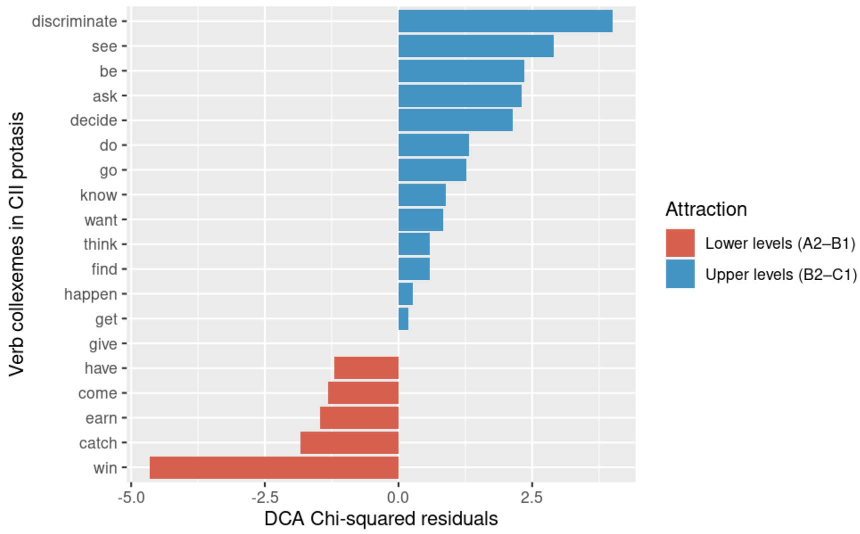

Figure 1: Residuals of the χ^2-test

4 Discussion

5 Conclusion

References

Jeroen Geertzen, Theodora Alexopoulou, Anna Korhonen, et al. Automatic linguistic annotation of large scale L2 databases: The EF-Cambridge Open Language Database (EF-CAMDAT). In *Proceedings of the 31st Second Language Research Forum. Somerville, MA: Cascadilla Proceedings Project*, pages 240–254, 2013.